sheltered in FATA. Afghan government and later on the US and British forces could not stop them from entering Pakistan from these areas. Border management had been non-existent as Afghanistan has always opposed Pakistan's attempts to fence the border to stop unauthorised border crossing. However, the Durand Line, the border between Pakistan and Afghanistan that was legally settled by the British rulers even before the creation of Pakistan, is secured, with which Afghanistan disagreed.

The US and allied forces at least helped establish a democratic government in Kabul and kept the Taliban at bay to an extent. However, Taliban insurgency could not be quelled to the hilt. Rather it is still raging hard in Afghanistan. Pakistan is presently in a perplexing position. It had once recognised the Taliban government and extended them support too, as it had provided earlier on to millions of Afghan refugees during the Soviet–Mujahideen War. Even the former Afghan President Hamid Karzai and present President Ashraf Ghani had enjoyed this hospitality for years. It was natural hospitality due to geographical contiguity and tribal affinity, from which stemmed the state policy too. Despite Afghanistan's protest, it is as difficult for Pakistan to compel Taliban supporters to leave Pakistan as it is to Afghan refugees. Moreover, any stringent action against them can agitate their militarised groups like the Haqqani network that can create further violence in Pakistan.

As the dreaded TTP was compelled to leave North Waziristan as a result of military operation 'Zarb-e-Azb', it shifted its command and control structures to Kunar and Nuristan provinces of Afghanistan, from where it kept launching terrorist attacks in urban centres of Pakistan. They were defeated by Pakistan military in North Waziristan as they have been provided strategic depth in Afghanistan.

There is little hope that Afghanistan will become stable any time soon. The former British Ambassador to Afghanistan, Sir William Patey, had stated that Afghanistan will remain a fragile, unstable, corrupt state long after the British troops have departed (*The Telegraph*, August 2012).[9] The spillover of violence and the inability of the Kabul government to control it would continue to affect Pakistan, especially its tribal areas.

THE MAIN CONCERN

The following factors are of main concern: Al Qaeda, TTP and Afghan Taliban.